

Amid these movements, the NIA has failed to find its moorings. It functions at less than half strength—only 45 personnel including seven IPS officers and Director Radha Vinod Raju. In a hurry to show results, Chidambaram handed over three cases to the NIA—two cases of terror by the Dima Halim Daogah in Assam and a fake currency case. Not exactly the high profile cases the NIA was set up to probe.

SECURING THE COASTS

FLAW Lack of coordination among security agencies, lack of speed boats

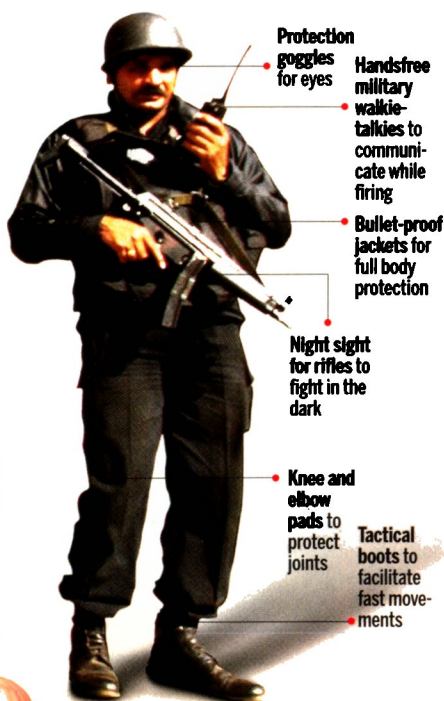
SOLUTION Creating 82 coastal police stations and the MSA

3/10 STORY SO FAR 6 stations created, no MSA, 13 new boats

Marine police officials onboard slow fishing trawlers. This is currently the scenario of the marine police, which has to patrol a 5-km belt of coastline post 26/11. The reason?

Stuck in Red Tape

The NSG will have to wait 6-12 months to be fully geared up



Not enough boats to go around. The Home Ministry sanctioned the building of 168 speedboats at the state-owned defence shipyards in Goa and Kolkata. There are two speedboats, a 12-tonne fast patrol boat and a five-tonne patrol craft. Since April, 14 interceptor boats have been dispatched to Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Kerala, Lakshadweep and Tamil Nadu. Each of the proposed 78 marine police stations (on the west coast) are to be equipped with these boats. Both shipyards have to deliver six boats a month if they are to equip all the marine police stations with 168 boats by next year. "The rate of production is far from satisfactory. The shipyards must speed up production," says a senior Coast Guard official.

One of the recommendations of the Kargil Review Committee accepted by the Government was the appointment of a maritime security adviser (MSA) who would coordinate with 15 agencies dealing with coastal security. The proposal was revived following 26/11 and the navy even earmarked a vice admiral and a secretariat. However, the proposal did not even go to the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS). The reasons? Turf wars. The navy wanted the MSA to report directly to the national security adviser but the home minister wanted the MSA to report to him. So while the Government has given the overall responsibility of coastal security to the navy, it is silent on appointing an MSA.

WEAK MUMBAI POLICE

FLAW Lack of modern arms and equipment to fight terror attacks

SOLUTION SWAT units, better arms and special training

STORY SO FAR No BPs and only three bullet-proof vehicles

2/10

One of the most pathetic sights of 26/11 was of Mumbai Police constables armed with Lee Enfield rifles from World War I standing cluelessly around the sites of the attack. Things

PRASHANT CHAUHARY



have not improved much. The state Government announced the setting up of Force One, an anti-terrorist strike force of 350 specially-trained personnel, but has not got the land for the force. A 25-acre plot, earmarked for Force One, near the airport in Santa Cruz was handed over to the NSG to set up its Mumbai hub. The Mumbai Police then procured US-made equipment like the Colt M-4 for the Force One despite several questions raised by the NSG. Some objections include the non-evaluation of competing weapon systems and the non-compatibility of these weapons with existing firearms. It has led precisely to the situation that security analysts had warned: multiple police organisation running around to buy their own equipment without consulting the army or the NSG. The Mumbai Police has now gone slow on the procurement of 900 fresh bulletproof jackets (BPJ). The only equipment they have received are three bulletproof vehicles and 120 motorcycles. Only one of the six coastal police stations in Mumbai has been set up.